



Subject Vision and Intent: Art

Our Vision

At King's Cross Academy, we believe that Art & Design gives children a powerful means through which to observe, understand and respond to the world around them. Our ambition is for every child to leave KCA seeing themselves as an artist: confident in expressing their own ideas, willing to experiment and equipped with the knowledge and skills to turn their creative thinking into something meaningful.

Creativity is central to learning at KCA. Through Art, children have the freedom to imagine possibilities, make connections, take creative risks and develop ideas that are uniquely their own. We want children to understand that there is not always one correct response and that their individual experiences, identities and perspectives can shape the art they create.

Our Art curriculum reflects our Academy vision, *Love Learning Together*. Children encounter the work and ideas of artists from different cultures, traditions, places and periods while developing their own artistic voice. Art also provides powerful opportunities to develop our KCA values: the courage to experiment, the respect to engage thoughtfully with the work of others, the endurance to practise and refine, and the aspiration to create work that communicates something meaningful.

Our Intent

Our Art & Design curriculum is ambitious, inclusive and carefully sequenced. It identifies the essential knowledge, vocabulary, techniques and artistic understanding we want children to develop from the Early Years to Year 6, enabling them to become increasingly confident, skilled and independent artists.

Children develop their knowledge and practical skills through experiences of drawing, painting, sculpture and other art, craft and design techniques and media. Skills are deliberately taught, practised and revisited so that children develop increasing control and confidence while building a repertoire of techniques from which they can make purposeful artistic choices.

Alongside developing technical skill, children learn to think as artists. They observe closely, investigate materials, experiment with possibilities, make connections, generate ideas and make creative decisions. We encourage children to move beyond simply reproducing a

predetermined outcome and increasingly make choices about how they want their own work to develop.

Children encounter the work of artists, craftspeople and designers from different times, places, cultures and traditions. They learn about the ideas, techniques and contexts that have shaped the work of others and consider how art both reflects and influences the societies in which it is created. These encounters provide inspiration while broadening children's understanding of what art can be and who can be an artist.

Our children use sketchbooks as an important part of their development as artists. Sketchbooks provide a space to observe, explore, practise, experiment, record ideas and reflect upon how their work develops. As children progress through the school, their sketchbooks increasingly demonstrate the journey from an initial idea through experimentation and refinement towards a final piece.

We want children to understand that artistic development involves experimentation. Ideas will change, techniques will sometimes be unsuccessful and finished work may look different from what was originally imagined. At KCA, these moments are an important part of learning. Children are encouraged to reflect, adapt and try again rather than seeing an unexpected outcome as failure.

Vocabulary is explicitly taught and revisited so that children develop the language needed to describe techniques, materials and artistic choices and to discuss and evaluate their own work and the work of others with increasing precision.

Every Child

We have high expectations for every child. Children with SEND, children who are disadvantaged and children who are developing English as an additional language access the same ambitious Art & Design curriculum.

Teachers identify the essential knowledge and skills that all children need and adapt teaching, materials, tools and levels of support so that barriers are reduced without limiting creativity or lowering expectations. Explicit modelling, visual resources, opportunities for repeated practice and access to a broad range of materials enable every child to participate and develop their artistic independence.

Art provides children with different ways to communicate ideas and experiences. We value this particularly for children who may find other forms of expression more challenging. There is no single way to be successful as an artist, and children are encouraged to recognise the value of their individual perspectives and creative choices.

We recognise that children's opportunities to encounter art, artists and cultural institutions beyond school can vary considerably. Our curriculum therefore ensures that every child experiences ambitious art education, encounters significant works of art and has opportunities to experience art within galleries, exhibitions and the creative community beyond school.

Art Beyond the Curriculum

Our location provides exceptional opportunities to extend children's artistic experiences beyond the classroom. King's Cross is home to a vibrant creative community, and we deliberately build connections between children's curriculum learning and the artists, institutions and cultural spaces that surround our school.

Our partnerships and experiences with neighbouring institutions, including Central Saint Martins and the Aga Khan Centre, provide children with opportunities to encounter artists, creative professionals, exhibitions and new ways of thinking about art and design.

Whole-school opportunities such as Art Week bring our community together through creativity, while participation in wider events such as the Camden Schools Art Biennale provides authentic opportunities for children's work to be exhibited and celebrated beyond the classroom.

We want children to experience galleries and exhibitions not as places that belong to somebody else, but as spaces in which they are entitled to participate, explore and be inspired. These experiences broaden children's understanding of creative careers and demonstrate that art and design are living disciplines that exist all around them.

By the end of Year 6, our aim is not simply that children can use a range of artistic techniques successfully. We want them to draw upon their knowledge of materials, techniques and artists to develop ideas of their own; to experiment, make purposeful choices, reflect and refine; and to communicate something of their own perspective through what they create.

Above all, we want children to leave KCA as confident, curious and individual artists who understand that their ideas have value, have the skills to express those ideas creatively and have developed an appreciation of the extraordinary breadth of art that exists in the world around them.